Chapter 4: Project Integration Management

Information Technology Project Management, Eighth Edition

Note: See the text itself for full citations.

Twittie Senivongse (ed.)

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Learning Objectives (1 of 2)

- Describe an overall framework for project integration management as it relates to the other project management knowledge areas and the project life cycle
- Discuss the strategic planning process and apply different project selection methods
- Explain the importance of creating a project charter to formally initiate projects
- Describe project management plan development, understand the content of these plans, and describe approaches for creating them
- Explain project execution, its relationship to project planning, the factors related to successful results, and tools and techniques to assist in directing and managing project work

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Learning Objectives (2 of 2)

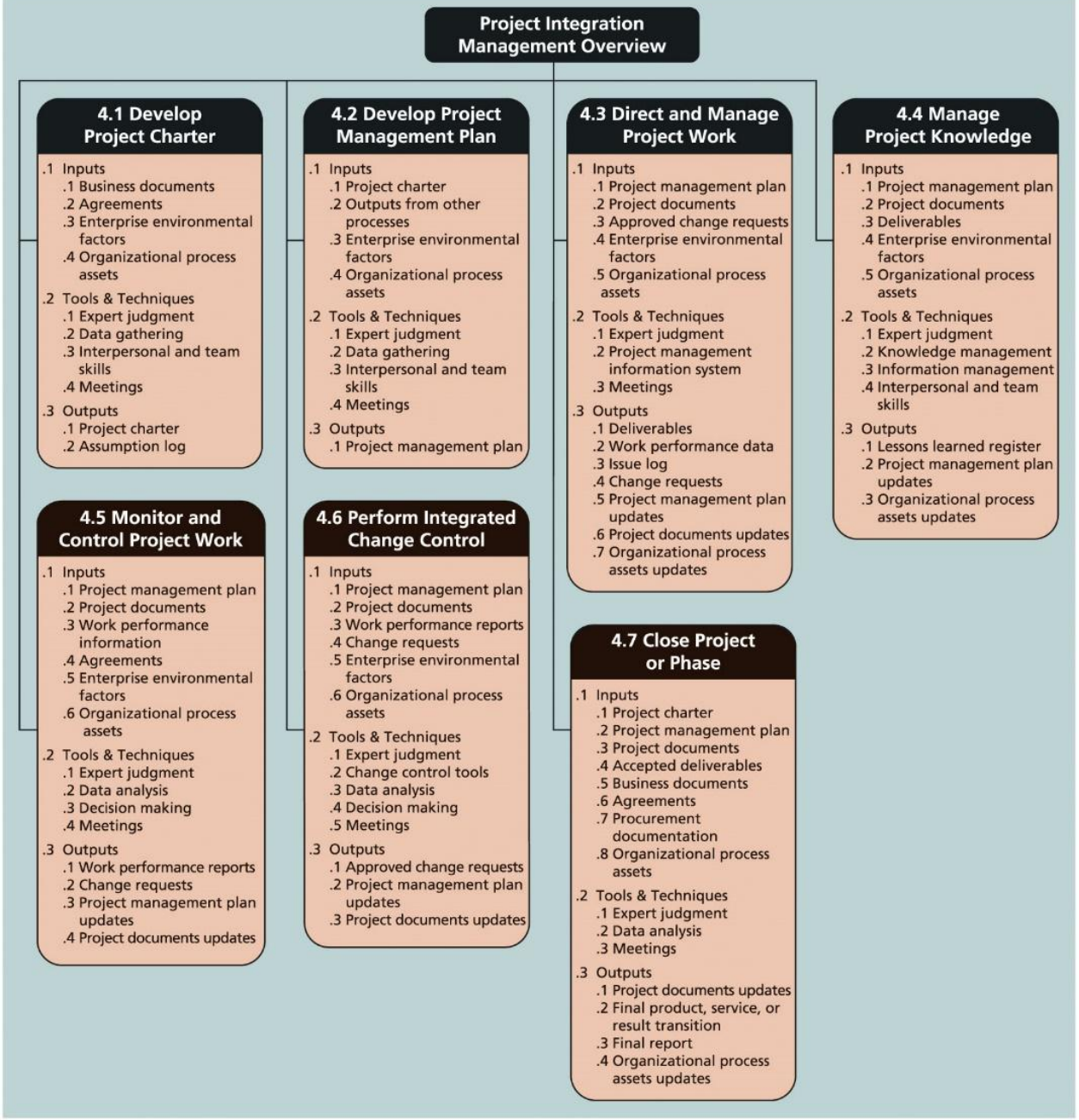
- Apply the principles of knowledge management to the various aspects of project integration
- Describe the process of monitoring and controlling a project
- Define the integrated change control process, relate this to the steps for planning for and managing changes on information technology (IT) projects, and create an appropriate change control system for a project that incorporates both
- Explain the importance of developing and following good procedures for closing projects
- Describe how software can assist in project integration management
- Discuss considerations for agile/adaptive environments

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Project Integration Management

- Involves coordinating all other project management knowledge areas throughout a project's life cycle
- Main processes (PMBOK® Guide, Sixth Edition, 2017)
  1. Developing the project charter
  2. Developing the project management plan
  3. Directing and managing project work
  4. Managing project knowledge
  5. Monitoring and controlling project work
  6. Performing integrated change control
  7. Closing the project or phase

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Source: Project Management Institute, Inc. *A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge, (PMBOK® Guide) – Sixth Edition* (2017), Figure 4-1, Page 71.

FIGURE 4-1 Project integration management summary

Strategic Planning to Help Identify Potential Projects (1 of 3)

- The first step in project management is deciding what projects to do
- Strategic planning involves determining long-term objectives of an organization
  - Analyzing the strengths and weaknesses of an organization
  - Studying opportunities and threats in the business environment
  - Predicting future trends
  - Projecting the need for new IT products and services to support the organization's objectives
- SWOT analysis
  - Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats

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Strategic Planning to Help Identify Potential Projects (2 of 3)

Example: SWOT Analysis for a Mid-Sized Hotel

Suppose **ABC Hotel** is a 100-room independent hotel. It currently accepts reservations mainly by phone, email, and third-party booking platforms.

Strengths	Weaknesses
Good reputation and many repeat customers	Reservations are partly handled manually using spreadsheets
Experienced hotel staff	No direct online booking on the hotel's website
Good location near tourist attractions	Staff spend significant time answering availability inquiries
Existing website and social-media presence	Customer and reservation data are stored in separate systems
Strong relationships with local tour operators	Heavy dependence on third-party booking platforms

Opportunities	Threats
More customers prefer booking hotels online	Competitors provide convenient online booking
Growing number of international tourists	Third-party platforms charge significant commissions
Online payment is increasingly common	Customers may switch to hotels with better digital services
Customer data could support personalized promotions	Cybersecurity and customer-data privacy risks
AI/chatbots could provide 24-hour customer service	Large hotel chains have larger technology budgets

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Strategic Planning to Help Identify Potential Projects (3 of 3)

SWOT finding	Business need / opportunity	Possible software project
W: No direct online booking + **O:** Customers increasingly book online	Enable customers to book without contacting staff	**Online Hotel Reservation System**
W: Heavy reliance on third-party platforms + **T:** High platform commissions	Increase direct bookings	**Direct Booking Website/Web App**
W: Customer data stored separately + **O:** Personalized promotions	Better use of customer information	**Customer Relationship Management (CRM) System**
W: Staff answer many repetitive inquiries + **O:** AI chatbot technology	Reduce staff workload and improve response time	**AI Hotel Customer-Service Chatbot**
S: Many repeat customers + **O:** Personalized digital marketing	Improve customer retention	**Hotel Loyalty and Rewards System**
T: Competitors offer better digital services + **W:** Manual processes	Improve overall customer experience	**Integrated Hotel Guest-Service Platform**

For example, the company might select the **Online Hotel Reservation System** because it addresses several SWOT factors simultaneously:

Business justification:
The project addresses the weakness of manual reservation processing, exploits the growth of online booking, reduces dependency on third-party booking platforms, and helps the hotel respond to competitors that already provide online reservation services.

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Identifying Potential Projects

- Apart from using a SWOT analysis, organizations often follow a process for project selection

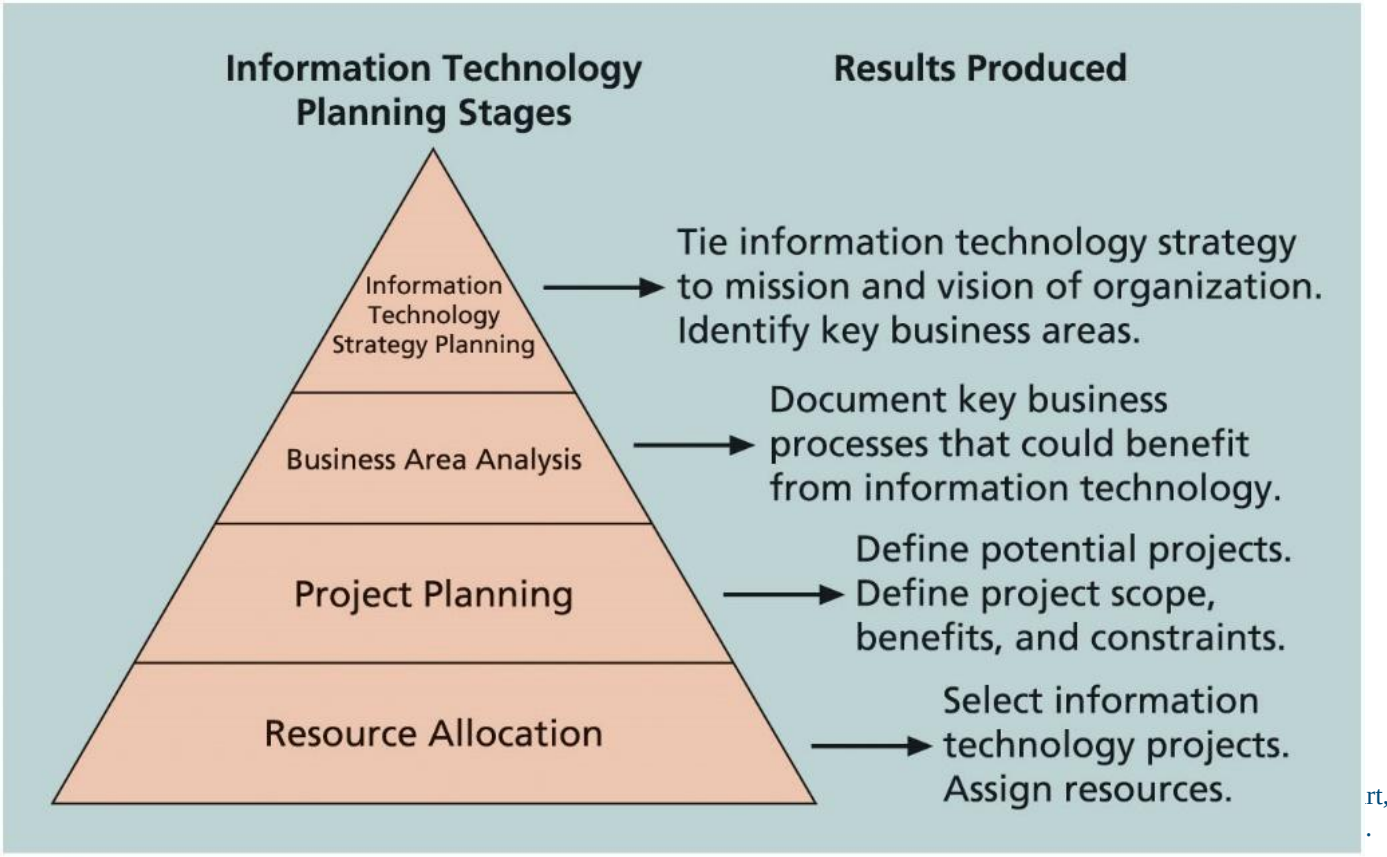


FIGURE 4-3 Planning process for selecting IT projects

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Methods for Selecting Projects

- Potential projects must be narrowed down
- Methods for selecting projects
  - Focusing on broad organizational needs
  - Categorizing information technology projects
  - Performing net present value or other financial analyses
  - Using a weighted scoring model
- Organizations use a combination of these approaches to select projects

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Focusing on Broad Organizational Needs

- Projects that address broad organizational needs are much more likely to be successful because they will be important to the organization
  - Examples: improve customer service, provide better communication, improve safety, increase morale
- Important criteria for selecting projects
  - Need
    - Do people in the organization agree that the project needs to be done?
  - Funding
    - Does the organization have the capacity to provide adequate funds to do the project?
  - Will
    - Is there a strong will to make the project succeed?

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Categorizing IT Projects

- Categorization for selecting projects
  - Problems
    - Current or anticipated situations that prevent an organization from achieving its goals
  - Opportunities
    - Chances to improve the organization
  - Directives
    - New requirements imposed by management, government, or external influence
  - Timing
    - How long it will take to complete the project and the deadline for completing it, e.g. otherwise it is no longer a valid project
  - Priority
    - High, medium, or low based on business environment, e.g cost-cutting project is of high priority and should be done first

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Performing Financial Analyses

- Financial considerations are often an important consideration in selecting projects
- Primary methods for determining the projected financial value of projects
  - Net present value (NPV) analysis
  - Return on investment (ROI)
  - Break-even point and payback analysis
- Often with 3–5-year analysis horizon for investment decisions because benefits and costs farther into the future become increasingly uncertain.

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Net Present Value Analysis (1 of 2)

- Method of calculating the expected net monetary gain or loss from a project by discounting all expected future cash inflows and outflows to the present point in time
  - Determine estimated values of costs and benefits for the project and product
  - Determine the discount rate and discounted value (present value or PV)
  - Calculate the net present value (benefit – cost)
- Depending on the organization's financial procedure,
  - First year may be year 0 or year 1
  - Discount rate may vary, often based on the prime rate (the rate at which the organization could borrow money for the project)
- Projects with NPV > 0 means the project adds values and should be considered if financial value is a key criterion
  - Projects with higher positive NPVs are preferred

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Net Present Value Analysis (2 of 2)

Discount rate	8%					
Assume the project is completed in Year 0			Year			
	0	1	2	3	Total	
Costs	140,000	40,000	40,000	40,000		
Discount factor	1	0.93	0.86	0.79		
Discounted costs PV	**140,000**	**37,200**	**34,400**	**31,600**	**243,200**	
Benefits	0	200,000	200,000	200,000		
Discount factor	1	0.93	0.86	0.79		
Discounted benefits PV	**0**	**186,000**	**172,000**	**158,000**	**516,000**	
Discounted benefits - costs	(140,000)	148,800	137,600	126,400	**272,800**	←NPV
Cumulative benefits - costs	(140,000)	8,800	146,400	272,800		
ROI →	**112%**	(272,800/243,200*100)				
	Payback in Year 1	(or 0.94 (Break-even point = (|-140,000|/148,800)+0 = 0.94))				

Discounted cash flow or

or Cumulative discounted cash flow

FIGURE 4-5 JWD Consulting net present value and return on investment example

Assumptions	
Costs	# hours
PM (500 hours, $50/hour)	25,000
Staff (1,500 hours, $70/hour)	105,000
Outsourced software and services	10,000
Total project costs (all applied in year 0)	140,000
Benefits	
# consultants	400
Hours saved	40
$/hour profit	10
Benefits from saving time	160,000
Benefits from 1% increase in profits	40,000
Total annual projected benefits	200,000

$$Discount\ factor = \frac{1}{(1+r)^t}$$

$$t = Year\ of\ cash\ flow,\ \ r = Discount\ rate$$

$$Present\ Value\ (PV) = Amount * Discount\ factor$$

$$ROI = \left(\frac{NPV}{\sum Discounted\ total\ costs} \right) * 100$$

$$Net\ Present\ Value\ (NPV) = \sum (Discounted\ benefit - Discounted\ cost)$$
$$= \sum Discounted\ cash\ flow$$

$$Break-Even\ Point \quad --- calculated\ at\ the\ first\ year\ with\ positive\ discounted\ cash\ flow$$
$$= \left(\frac{|Cumulative\ discounted\ cash\ flow\ of\ the\ previous\ year|}{Discounted\ cash\ flow\ of\ the\ year} \right) + previous\ year$$

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Return on Investment

- Calculated by subtracting the project costs from the benefits and then dividing by the costs
  - ROI = ((total discounted benefits - total discounted costs) / total discounted costs)*100
- The ROI is always a percentage and can be positive or negative
- The higher the ROI, the better
- Many organizations have a required rate of ROI
  - E.g. Minimum acceptable rate of ROI of 10%
- Also, Internal Rate of Return (IRR) can be calculated by finding the discount rate that makes the NPV equal to zero
  - The higher the IRR, the better
  - E.g. IRR of JWD project is around 100%

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Payback Analysis (1 of 2)

- Payback period is the amount of time it will take to recoup the total amount invested in a project, in the form of net cash inflows
  - Determines how much time will elapse before accrued benefits overtake accrued and continuing costs
  - Payback occurs when the cumulative discounted benefits equals the cumulative discounted costs (i.e. at break-even point)
  - Many organizations have requirements for the length of the payback period of an investment
    - Within the analysis period is a good sign, but risk increases toward the end of the period

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Payback Analysis (2 of 2)

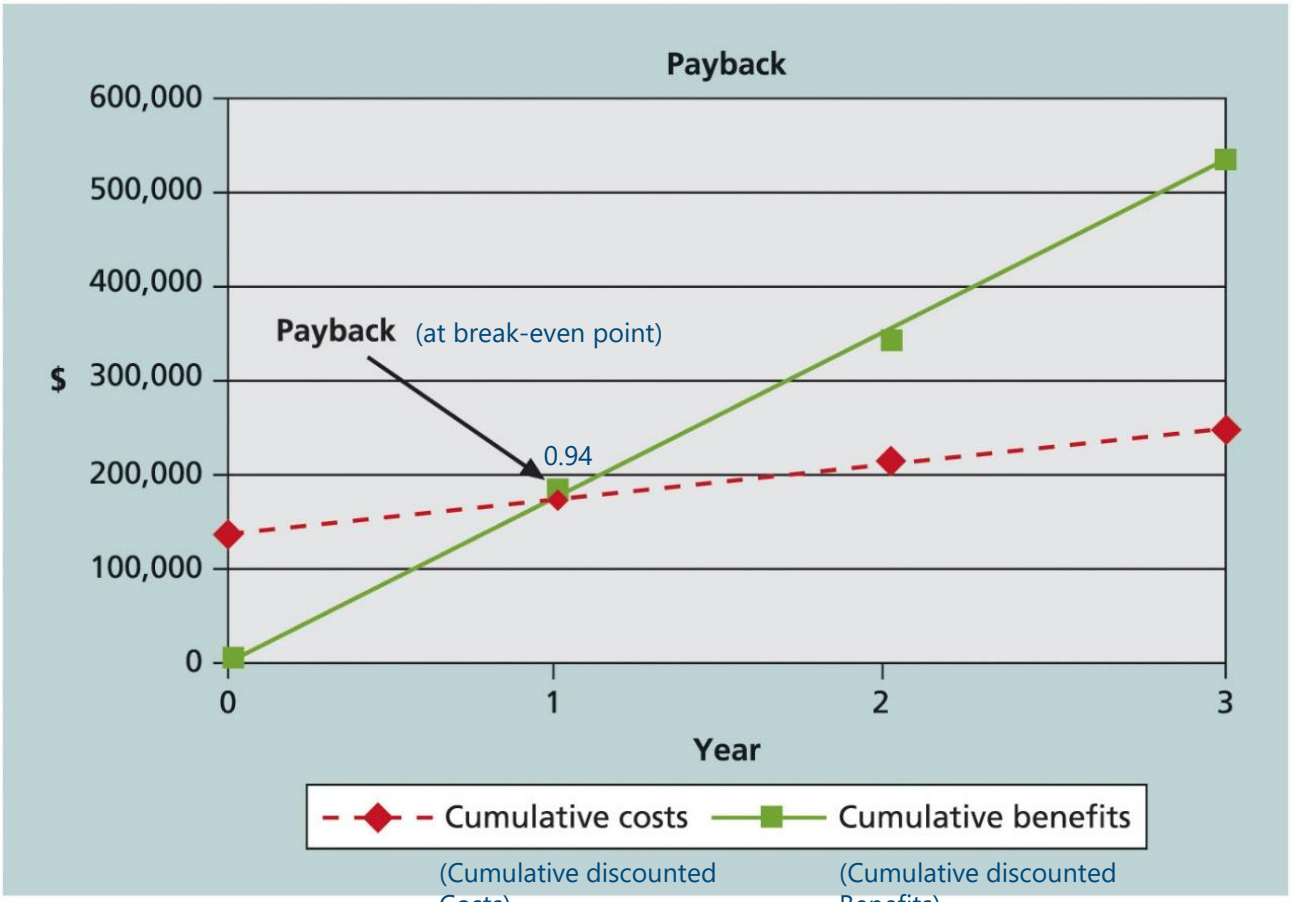


FIGURE 4-6 Charting the payback period for the JWD Consulting project

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Using a Weighted Scoring Model (1 of 2)

- Provides a systematic process for selecting projects based on many criteria
  - Identify criteria important to the project selection process
  - Assign weights (percentages) to each criterion so they add up to 100%
  - Assign scores to each criterion for each project
  - Multiply the scores by the weights and get the total weighted scores

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Using a Weighted Scoring Model (2 of 2)

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	**Criteria**	**Weight**	**Project 1**	**Project 2**	**Project 3**	**Project 4**
2	Supports key business objectives	25%	90	90	50	20
3	Has strong internal sponsor	15%	70	90	50	20
4	Has strong customer support	15%	50	90	50	20
5	Uses realistic level of technology	10%	25	90	50	70
6	Can be implemented in one year or less	5%	20	20	50	90
7	Provides positive NPV	20%	50	70	50	50
8	Has low risk in meeting scope, time, and cost goals	10%	20	50	50	90
9	**Weighted Project Scores**	**100%**	**56**	**78.5**	**50**	**41.5**



FIGURE 4-7 Sample weighted scoring model for project selection

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1. Developing a Project Charter

- After deciding what project to work on, it is important to let the rest of the organization know
  - A project charter is a document that formally recognizes the existence of a project and provides direction on the project's objectives and management
  - It authorizes the project manager to use organizational resources
  - See example in chapter 3
- Key project stakeholders should sign a project charter to acknowledge agreement on the need and intent of the project
  - A project charter is a key output of the initiating process

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2. Developing a Project Management Plan (1 of 2)

- A project management plan is used to coordinate all project planning documents and help guide a project's execution and control
  - Plans created in the other knowledge areas are subsidiary parts of the overall project management plan
  - A small project (e.g. involving a few people over a few months) would not need a separate project management plan (only project charter, scope statement, and Gantt chart might be needed)
- Common elements of a project management plan
  - Introduction/overview of the project
  - Description of how the project is organized
  - Management and technical processes (including project life cycle description and development approach)
  - Work to be done (scope)
  - Schedule and budget information
  - References to other project planning documents

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Developing a Project Management Plan (2 of 2)

Major Section Headings	Section Topics
Overview	Purpose, scope, and objectives; assumptions and constraints; project deliverables; schedule and budget summary; evolution of the plan
Project Organization	External interfaces; internal structure; roles and responsibilities
Managerial Process Plan	Start-up plans (estimation, staffing, resource acquisition, and project staff training plans); work plan (work activities, schedule, resource, and budget allocation); control plan; risk management plan; closeout plan
Technical Process Plans	Process model; methods, tools, and techniques; infrastructure plan; product acceptance plan
Supporting Process Plans	Configuration management plan; verification and validation plan; documentation plan; quality assurance plan; reviews and audits; problem resolution plan; subcontractor management plan; process improvement plan
…	…

Source: IEEE Standard 1058–1998.

Table 4-3 Sample contents for the IEEE software project management plan (SPMP) (Partial)

See example - MSG



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3. Directing and Managing Project Work

- Involves managing and performing the work described in the project management plan
- The project manager needs to focus on leading the project team and managing stakeholder relationships to execute the project management plan successfully
- Organizational culture can help project execution
  - Providing guidelines and templates
  - Tracking performance based on plans

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Capitalizing on Product, Business, and Application Area Knowledge

- It is often helpful for IT project managers to have prior technical experience
  - Small projects
    - The project manager may be required to perform some of the technical work or mentor team members to complete the projects
  - Large projects
    - The project manager must understand the business and application area of the project, as the main responsibility is to lead the team and communicate with stakeholders

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Project Execution Tools and Techniques

- Project managers can use specific tools and techniques to perform activities that are part of execution processes
  - Expert judgment
    - Do not hesitate to consult experts on different topics
  - Meetings
    - Develop relationships, pick up body language and tone of voice, have a dialogue to help resolve problems
    - Various meetings for different stakeholders, e.g. meet from time to time with senior management, meet more regularly with team members
  - Project management information systems
    - Should delegate the detailed work involved to other supporting team members

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4. Managing Project Knowledge

- Basic types of knowledge
  - Explicit knowledge
    - Easily explained using words, pictures, or numbers and easy to communicate, store, and distribute, e.g. project documents and plans
  - Tacit knowledge
    - Difficult to express and highly personal, e.g. belief, insight, experience
    - Often shared through conversations and interactions between people, e.g. mentorships, communities of practice, workshops
- Knowledge management should be done before, during, and after projects are completed
- Buidling a culture of trust and sharing, passing on tacit knowledge
  - Lessons-learned register, describing situation and recommendation
    - Documented throughout the project life cycles by team members and archived in a lessons-learned repository

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5. Monitoring and Controlling Project Work

- Monitoring project work includes collecting, measuring, assessing, and disseminating performance information
- Project team should monitor the project performance to identify areas that require attention
- A baseline is a starting point, measurement, or observation that is documented and used for future comparison
  - E.g. work to perform, schedule, and cost baseline in the project plan
  - If changes are caused during execution, revise the project plan
- Important outputs
  - Work performance report, e.g. status report, progress report
  - Schedule and cost forecasts
  - Change requests

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6. Performing Integrated Change Control

- Change is unavoidable, e.g. technology, personnel, organizational priority changes
- Project manager and team must make trade-off between scope, time, cost, quality
- Communicate changes to top management and key stakeholders
- Important outputs
  - Approved change requests
  - Updated project plan
  - Updated project documents

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Change Control on IT Projects

- Former view: the project team should strive to do exactly what was planned on time and within budget
- Problem: project teams could rarely meet original project goals
- Modern view: project management is a process of constant communication and negotiation
- Solution: changes are often beneficial and the project team should plan for them

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Change Control System (1 of 4)

- Formal, documented process that describes when and how official project documents and work may be changed
  - Describes who is authorized to make changes, paperwork required for these changes, and any automated or manual tracking systems the project will use
- A change control system includes
  - Change control board
  - Configuration management
  - Process for communicating changes

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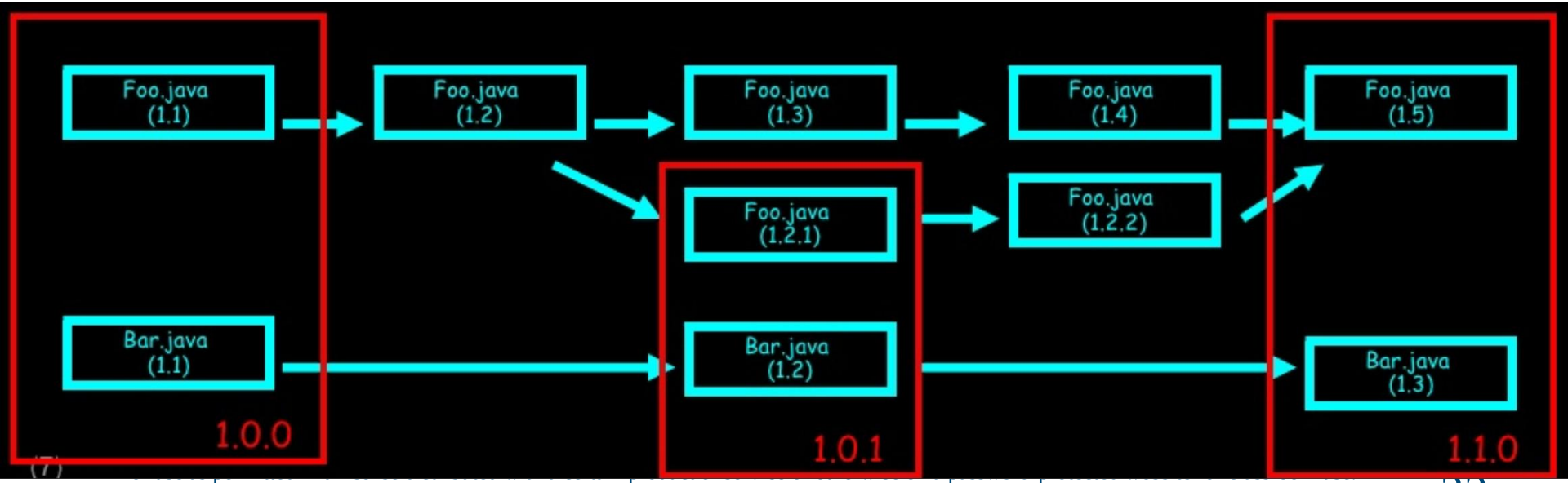
Change Control System (2 of 4)

- Change control board (CCB) is a formal group of people responsible for approving or rejecting changes on a project
  - Provide guidelines for preparing change requests, evaluate change requests, and manage the implementation of approved changes
  - Key stakeholders for the entire organization should be on this board
  - A few member could rotate based on the needs of each project
- Some CCBs only meet occasionally, so it may take too long for changes to occur
  - Some organizations have policies in place for time-sensitive changes, e.g. agreement must be reached by 48-hour policy

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Change Control System (3 of 4)

- Configuration management is about
  - Identifying the configuration of a system at discrete points in time
    - A configuration means an aggregate of versionable items
    - E.g. specification, design, documents, data, source code, executable code, test plan, test script, hardware, disks, software development environment (compilers, debuggers, emulators), project plan, and customer requirements
  - Controlling changes to this configuration
    - Maintaining the traceability of this configuration, having a historical records of old versions to trace changes throughout the project (version control)
  - Maintaining the integrity of this configuration
    - Auditing the product configuration to verify conformance to requirements



https://www.slideshare.net/philipmjohnson/introduction-to-version-control-and-configuration-management

Change Control System (4 of 4)

- Process for communicating changes is important to have everyone coordinated and informed about latest project information
- It involves
  - Timely notification of change to everyone affected
  - Written or formal communication
  - Oral or informal communication

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7. Closing Projects or Phases

- To close a project or phase, you must finalize all activities and transfer the completed or cancelled work to the appropriate people
- Main outputs
  - Project documents updates – marked as final version
  - Final product, service, or result, including
    - Transition plan
    - Written statement that the terms of contract were met or some type of project completion form
  - Final report and presentation
  - Organizational process assets updates, including
    - Project documentation
    - Project closure document
    - Historical information produced by the project in a useful format
    - Lessons-learned report
    - Post-implementation review information (if the project achieved what it sets out to do)

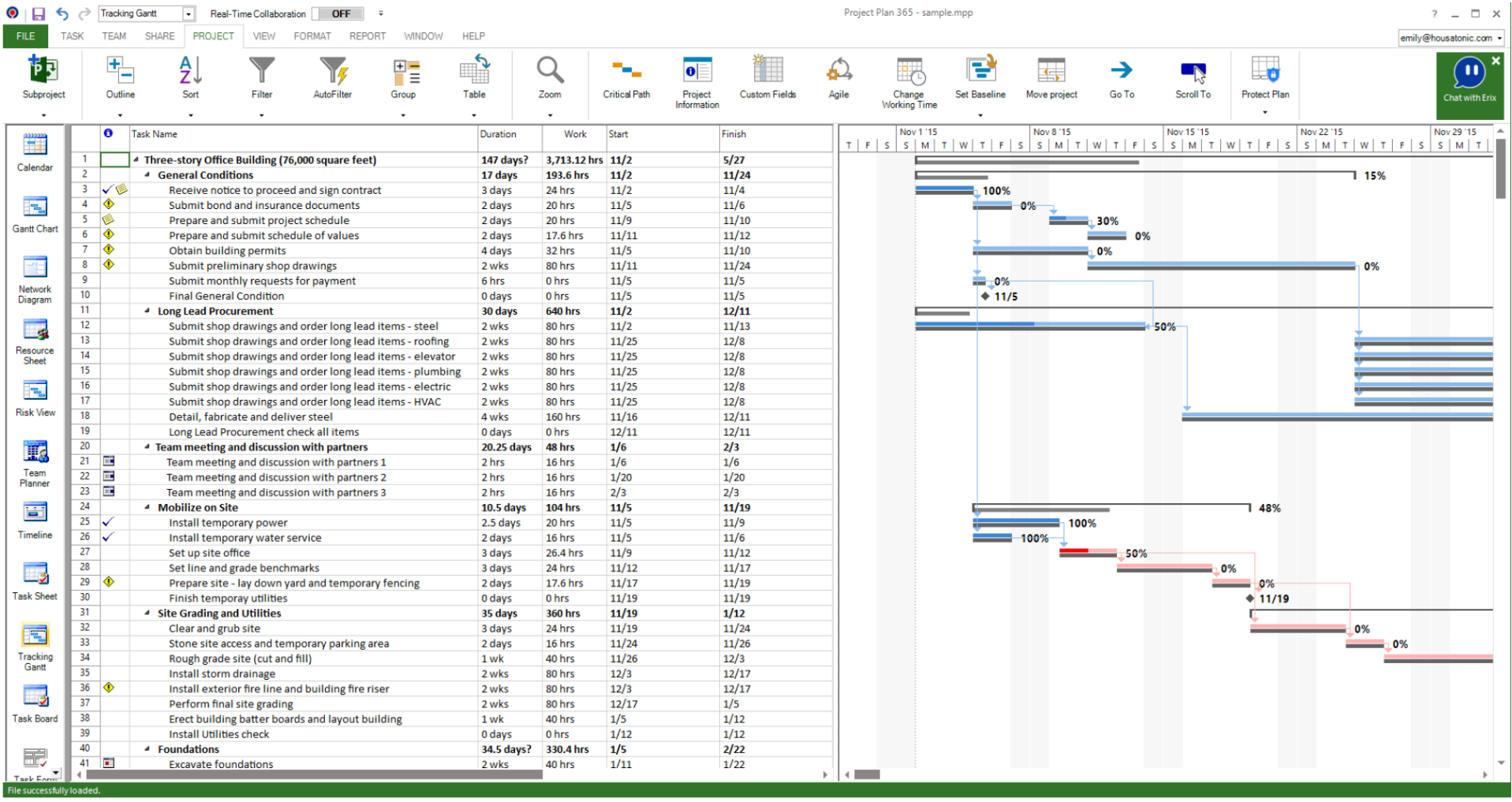
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Using Software to Assist in Project Integration Management (1 of 3)

- Several types of software can be used to assist in project integration management
  - Documents can be created with word processing software
  - Presentations are created with presentation software
  - Tracking can be done with spreadsheets or databases
  - Communication software can facilitate communications
  - Project management software can pull everything together and show detailed and summarized information

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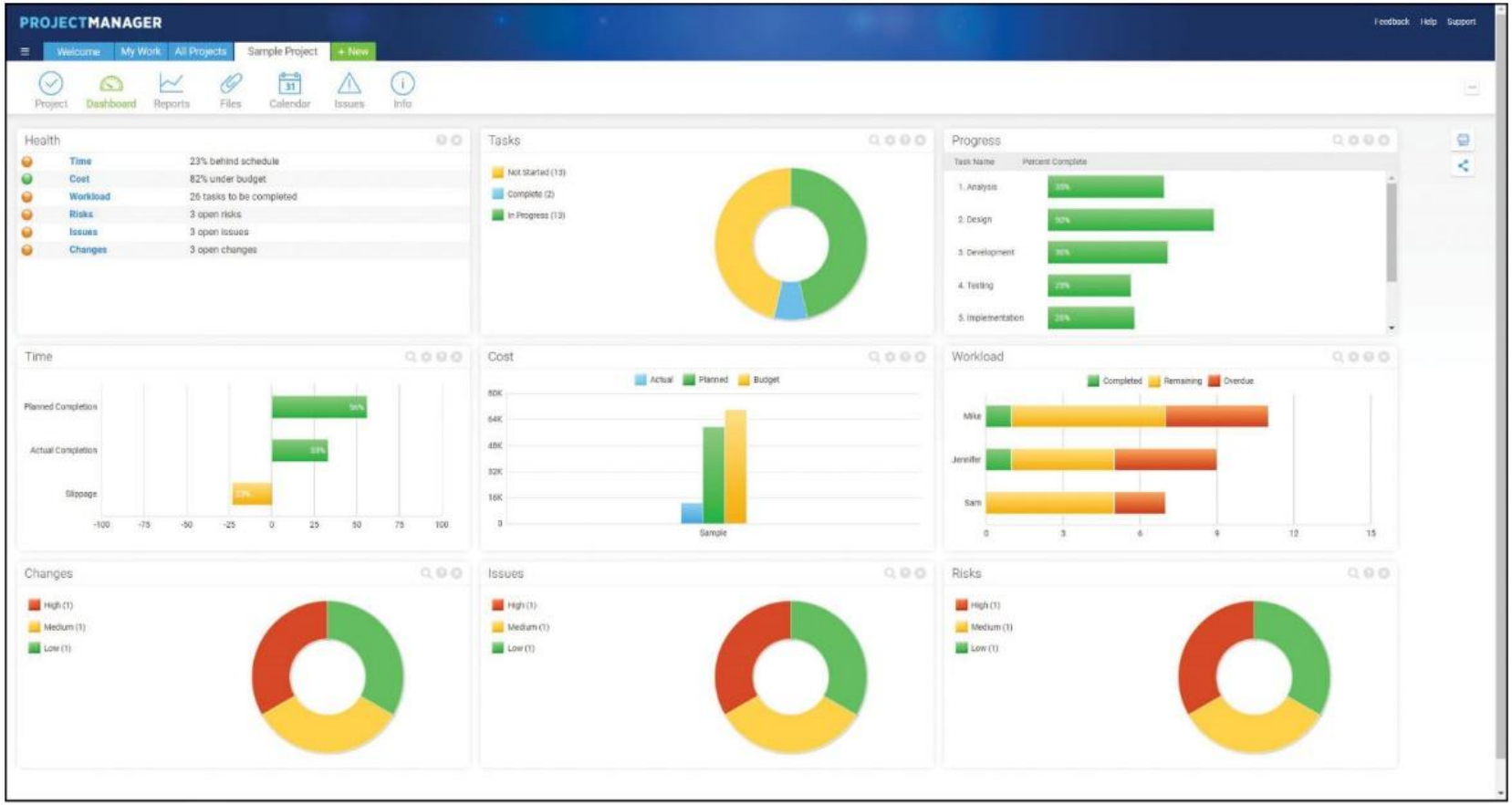
Using Software to Assist in Project Integration Management (2 of 3)



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https://www.projectplan365.com/articles/tracking-gantt/

Using Software to Assist in Project Integration Management (3 of 3)



Source: www.projectmanager.com

FIGURE 4-8 Sample portfolio management software screens

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Considerations for Agile/Adaptive Environments

- Iterative and agile approaches promote the engagement of team members
- Expectations of the project manager do not change in an adaptive environment, but control of the detailed product planning and delivery is delegated to the team
  - Unlike traditional projects where team members may not be directly involved in integration management but focus on specialized or technical skills
  - Project manager's focus is on building a collaborative decision-making environment and ensuring that the team has the ability to respond to changes and to develop additional skills

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Chapter Summary

- Project integration management ties together all the other areas of project management
- Main processes
  - Develop the project charter
  - Create an assumption log
  - Develop the project management plan
  - Direct and manage project execution
  - Manage project knowledge
  - Monitor and control project work
  - Perform integrated change control
  - Close the project or phase

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